Vintage 2024 Release Notes

The Vintage 2024 population estimates reflect the following methodological changes since the release of the Vintage 2023 estimates. For more detail, please refer to the full Vintage 2024 methodology statement: http://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/popest/technical-documentation/methodology.html.

Base Population

Whereas the latest decennial census has traditionally served as the population estimates base, the 2020 Census could not be adopted for this purpose. This was the result of unique challenges including the unavailability of specific data required for estimates processing and delays caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. As a result, the Population Estimates Program developed a process for integrating multiple data sources at varying levels of demographic and geographic detail to produce an estimate for April 1, 2020 that is referred to as the "blended base." The Vintage 2024 blended base for the United States did not feature changes relative to Vintage 2023.

For Puerto Rico, the Vintage 2024 blended base for Puerto Rico consists of the following:

- **2020 Census Data**: Commonwealth and municipio total resident, household, and GQ population counts (by facility type) [1] from the PL 94-171 Redistricting File.
- **Vintage 2020 Population Estimates for April 1, 2020**: Commonwealth and municipio population estimates by age, sex, and universe (including GQ facility type).

This represents a slight modification to Vintage 2023, where the GQ population data from the 2020 Census matched the totals for institutional/noninstitutional facilities, while the GQ type detail (by age and sex) came exclusively from Vintage 2020.

Vital Statistics Estimates

For Vintage 2024, we began a phased transition to estimating births and deaths with a single source of data at the subnational level. In previous vintages, representatives from the Federal-State Cooperative for Population Estimates (FSCPE) contributed data on the geographic distribution of recent vital events within their respective states, but many of the reasons for combining the National Center for Health Statistics (NCHS) and FSCPE data sources are no longer applicable. Mainly, the timeliness and completeness of the NCHS provisional data has surpassed what we are able to collect from the FSCPE. For Vintage 2024, we did not request any new or revised data from the FSCPE; however, we still included data received in previous vintages for years 2020 through 2022 (where applicable). Future vintages will fully remove the FSCPE data and use only the NCHS data at the national and subnational levels to estimate births and deaths.

[1] The seven major GQ facility types utilized in estimates production are: correctional institutions, juvenile institutions, nursing homes, other institutional facilities, college dormitories, military housing, and other noninstitutional facilities. While we do not release data on GQ by facility type, we do use them to calculate population universes such as "civilian noninstitutionalized."

Net International Migration Estimates

In the last three years, there has been a notable increase in the number of refugees, U.S. Border Patrol releases, and U.S. Customs and Border Protection Office of Field Operations' paroles. To account for this increase, we utilized new, reliable monthly administrative data on these humanitarian migrant cases from the U.S. Refugee Admissions Program and the Office of Homeland Security Statistics to enhance the estimates of non-U.S. born immigration described in the method statement.

The adjustment is applied at the national level by adding 75% of the humanitarian migrants to the ACS residence one year ago non-U.S.-born immigration estimate for each estimate year (July 1, 2021 - June 30, 2022; July 1, 2022 -June 30, 2023; and July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024). Similar to previous adjustments to international migration during the COVID-19 pandemic, this humanitarian migrant adjustment was specifically applied to the national total and distributed down to states and counties.

Although non-U.S.-born immigration is the only component of NIM that is directly adjusted, this impacts the net international migration estimate. Specifically, it results in increased national-level NIM totals for estimate years (July 1 to June 30) 2022, 2023 and 2024 when compared to Vintage 2023.

Note: The Census Bureau has reviewed this data product to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data used to produce this product (Data Management System (DMS) number: P-6000042 and P-7501659. Disclosure Review Board (DRB) approval number: CBDRB-FY25-0078).